

Sarena Yang

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EDUCATION

University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign

Graduation: May 2025

B.S. in Computer Science • GPA: 3.81/4.00

Relevant Coursework: Algorithms & Models of Computation, Computer Vision, Computational Photography, Computer Architecture Organization, Systems Programming, Intro to Data Mining

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Godaddy Inc., Software Development Engineer I

February 2025 - Present

- Maintained and optimized core backend email provisioning services using C# and .NET to manage email accounts and infrastructure for GoDaddy customers
- Resolved complex Tier-3 customer escalations requiring developer intervention, performing root-cause analysis and executing direct fixes to ensure service continuity
- Collaborated with Product Managers in Agile workflows to scope and plan future sprint deliverables
- Leveraged MySQL queries to inspect, debug, and validate database records during troubleshooting and system updates
- Participated in on-call rotations to monitor and ensure system health across services using telemetry and observability tools including New Relic and Site24x7

Godaddy Inc., Software Development Intern

May 2024 - August 2024

- Built API endpoint access tool utilizing C#, Javascript, and MySQL for email provisioning team that manages certificate authentication roles for internal teams
- Streamlined role management process by eliminating need to change multiple files and allowing updates without interrupting the sprint deployment cycle

Truth and Beauty, Video Production Director

January 2023 - August 2024

- Directed and produced video content for a collegiate dance group, managing end-to-end production pipelines, including filming and editing dance cover videos and social media posts
- Collaborated with dance cover leads to execute their creative vision and worked directly with the marketing team to establish promotional timelines, content deadlines, and distribution strategies
- Mentored and delegated tasks to junior video interns, coordinating projects to meet deadlines

HONORS & AWARDS

High Honors Graduation Distinction

May 2025

Third Place, Cyber 9/12 Strategy Challenge, Washington D.C.

March 2024

- Placed 3rd out of 43 university teams in a national cyber policy and crisis management competition,
- Authored policy briefs and delivered oral presentations to a panel of expert judges, defending strategic crisis response recommendations during a live Q&A cross-examination

Semi-Finalist, Cyber 9/12 Strategy Challenge, Austin

January 2024

- Selected as semi-finalist among 23 university teams, briefing policy judges on cyber threats

Dean's List

Fall 2021, Spring 2022, Fall 2023

SKILLS

Programming: Java, Python, C, C++, C#, SQL, HTML, CSS, JavaScript, OCaml

Technologies: React.js, Next.js, Typescript, Node.js, Flask, .NET, SQL Server, Oracle Database, MySQL

Languages: English, Mandarin